GG–F–340
28 APRIL 1949

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FILIFORMS; URETHRAL, WOVEN (BRAIDED)

This specification was approved by the Director, Bureau of Federal Supply, for the use of all departments and establishments of the Government.

1. CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Type and sizes.—Woven (braided) urethral filiforms covered by this specification shall be of but one type and of the following French scale sizes, as specified:

Size 3.—3 French.
Size 4.—4 French.
Size 5.—5 French.
Size 6.—6 French.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS

2.1 There are no other specifications applicable to this specification except those referenced in section 7 by individual departments.

(Copies of Federal specifications and the Federal Specifications Index may be obtained upon application, accompanied by postal note, money order, coupon, or cash, to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.)



FIGURE 1.—*Woven (braided) urethral filiform.*

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 *Yarn.*—Unless otherwise specified, the yarn shall be a good quality silk, linen, or nylon or other synthetic yarn. The nylon or other synthetic yarns shall have a melting point of not less than 135° C. when tested as described in 4.3.6. The yarn shall be free from toxic material or any ingredient which might have a deleterious effect upon body tissues, and shall have relatively high absorbent properties so that the maximum adhesion is secured between the base and coating.

3.1.2 *Coating.*—The coating shall be a flexible varnish, or suitable synthetic or plastic compound free from toxic material or any ingredient which might have a deleterious effect upon body tissues.

3.2 Design.—The filiforms shall be similar in design to that shown in figure 1, with an olive tip. The filiforms shall be 32±1 centimeters in length.

3.3 Metal fitting.—The metal fitting at the proximal end of the filiform shall be made of monel metal, brass, bronze, or other relatively noncorrosive metal or alloy. It shall have an American National standard screw-thread .073 inch in diameter, 56 internal threads per inch, of a depth sufficient to screw a male stud of like thread eight full turns. The diameter shall be 8 French in size.

3.4 Skeleton.—The skeleton shall be not over 2 inches in length and shall serve as the base upon which the proximal portion of the instrument is built and for attaching the metal fitting to the instrument with which it is to be used.

3.5 Core.—Each filiform shall have a core of a suitable material and of a size appropriate for the finished filiform. The core shall be securely fastened into the metal fitting and shall extend the full length of the instrument. Over this core at the fitting end shall be braided tubing to act as reinforcement at the point of greatest stress when the filiform is in use, and to provide gradual taper.

3.6 Body.—The body shall be a single tube covering the entire core and skeleton and shall be braided of yarns appropriate for the size of the filiform. The instrument shall gradually and smoothly decrease in diameter from the screw to a point approximately midway the length of the filiform. The filiform shall bend smoothly and evenly from the screw fitting when tested as described in 4.3.3.

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3.7 Coating.

3.7.1 *Characteristics.*—The coating (see 3.1.2) shall be designed to give maximum life in repeated use under actual working conditions. The coating shall be formulated to secure maximum adhesion to the base and thoroughly and uniformly impregnate in and around the braided yarns.

3.7.2 *Chemical properties.*—The chemical properties of the coating shall be such that when tested as described in 4.3.1, 4.3.2, 4.3.3, 4.3.4, and 4.3.5, the filiforms shall show no signs of brittleness, stickiness, blistering, swelling, or other visible damage.

3.8 Size.—The filiforms shall be all sizes 3 through 6 French scale. The point approximately midway the length of the main shaft of the filiform shall pass through the specific scale opening of the size designated, but not through the next smaller size opening of the French scale, when tested as described in 4.3.1. The diameter expressed in millimeters according to the French scale is numerically equal to one-third the scale size. The point approximately midway the length of the filiform shall determine the size.

3.9 Finish.—The surfaces shall be properly worked down to give a dry, smooth, flexible surface. The surface shall be "slick" when wet.

3.10 Identification marking.—Each filiform shall be plainly and indelibly marked upon the proximal end with the name or registered trade-mark of the manufacturer and the French scale size.

3.11 Workmanship.—The workmanship shall be first class throughout. The finished filiforms shall be symmetrical in shape, closely and regularly braided, and free from any irregularities or imperfections which will detract from their appearance or which may impair their serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling.—Unless otherwise specified, at least four filiforms of each size shall be taken at random from each lot of 200 or fraction thereof delivered, for inspection and tests.

4.2 Inspection.—Samples shall be inspected for compliance with this specification with respect to material, design, dimensions, finish, markings, workmanship and other applicable requirements.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Outside diameter.*—The outside diameter of all the sample filiforms shall be checked for size against a standard French scale. (See 3.8.)

4.3.2 *Boiling test.*—One filiform of each size shall be boiled for ten separate 3- to 5-minute periods. Between periods the filiforms shall be removed from the water, dried for 1 hour at 200° F., and then cooled to room temperature (68° to 72° F.).

4.3.3 *Bend test.*—The sample filiforms shall be held rigidly in a vertical position by the metal fitting and pulled to a horizontal position by the distal end.

4.3.4 *Autoclaving test.*—One filiform of each size shall be autoclaved for ten 10-minute intervals at 250° F. and cooled to room temperature (68° to 72° F.).

4.3.5 *Cleaning.*—One filiform of each size shall be cleaned by immersion in 70 percent alcohol for 5 minutes.

4.3.6 *Melting point.*—A piece of synthetic yarn approximately ⅛ inch long, taken from the base, shall be placed in a capillary tube closed at the lower end. The piece of yarn shall be attached to a partial immersion thermometer conforming to A. S. T. M. designation E1 (2C–39) (−5° to + 300° C.) (requirements for A. S. T. M. standard thermometers are contained in Federal Specification VV–L–791 under method No. 950.1) and immersed to the proper depth in a bath at a temperature of 135° C. for 5 minutes.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.—Unless otherwise specified, each filiform shall be packaged in accordance with accepted commercial practice.

5.2 Packing.—The subject commodity shall be prepared for shipment to permit acceptance by carrier for transportation at the lowest applicable rate and to afford maximum protection from normal hazards of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Packages.*—Unless otherwise specified, packages shall be marked with the name of the commodity, size, quantity contained therein,

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and the names of the contractor and manufacturer.

5.3.2 *Shipping containers.*—Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be marked with the name of the commodity, the size, and quantity contained therein, as defined by the contract or order under which the shipment is made, the name of the contractor, the number of the contract or order, and the gross weight.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.—Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and should specify the size required. (See 1.1, 3.1.1, 4.1, 5.1, 5.3, and 7.2.5.)

6.2 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with the requirements of this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.3 Federal specifications do not include all types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable for Federal Government requirements.

Patent notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

7. DEPARTMENTAL REQUIREMENTS

7.1 The following specifications and other publications, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification for purchases made under this specification by the respective departments.

7.2 Army and Navy.

7.2.1 *Applicable specifications and other publications.*—

Federal Specifications:

NN-B-601—Boxes; Wood - Cleated - Plywood, for Domestic Shipment.

NN-B-621—Boxes; Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.

NN-B-631—Boxes; Wood, Wire-bound, for Domestic Shipment.

Joint Army-Navy Specifications:

JAN-P-105—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Boxes, Wood, Cleated, Plywood.

JAN-P-106—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Boxes; Wood, Nailed.

JAN-B-107—Boxes; Wood, Wirebound (Overseas Type).

JAN-P-120—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Cartons, Folding, Paperboard.

JAN-P-125—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Barrier-Materials, Waterproof, Flexible.

JAN-P-133—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Boxes, Set-up, Paperboard.

JAN-P-140—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Adhesives, Water-Resistant, Case-Liner.

U. S. Army Specification:

100-2—Standard Specification for Marking Shipments by Contractors.[1]

Navy Department Specification:

General Specifications for Inspection of Material.[2]

Bureau of Supplies and Accounts Publication:

Navy Shipment Marking Handbook.[2]

[1] Applicable to Army purchases only.
[2] Applicable to Navy purchases only.

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(Copies of specifications required for Army purchases may be obtained upon application to the procuring agency. Both the title and identifying symbol or number should be stipulated when requesting copies.

(Copies of Federal and Joint Army-Navy specifications required for Navy purchases, Navy Department specifications, and the Navy Shipment Marking Handbook may be obtained without cost upon application to the Bureau of Supplies and Accounts, Navy Department, Washington 25, D. C., except that Naval activities should make application to the Supply Officer in Command, Naval Supply Center, Norfolk 11, Va. Both the title and identifying symbol or number should be stipulated when requesting copies of specifications.)

7.2.2 *Packaging.*

7.2.2.1 *Unit packages.*—One filiform constitutes one unit. Each unit shall be packaged (not coiled) in a glassine or waxed paper envelope and sealed. As an alternative, each unit may be wrapped (not coiled) in waxed or glassine paper and sealed.

7.2.2.2 *Intermediate packages.*—Twelve packaged units shall be further packaged in a snug-fitting, folding, paperboard carton or set-up paperboard box of appropriate size, conforming to the requirements of Joint Army-Navy Specifications JAN–P–120 and JAN–P–133, respectively. The cartons shall be adequately secured to prevent accidental opening.

7.2.3 *Packing.*

7.2.3.1 *Domestic.*—One hundred and twenty intermediate packages, 1,440 units, packaged as described in 7.2.2.2, shall be packed in a shipping container of appropriate size conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification NN–B–601, NN–B–621, or NN–B–631.

7.2.3.2 *Overseas.*—One hundred and twenty intermediate packages, 1,440 units, shall be packed in a shipping container of appropriate size, designed for type 2 load, conforming to the requirements of Joint Army-Navy Specification JAN–P–105, JAN–P–106, or JAN–B–107. Closure and strapping shall comply with the appendix to the applicable box specification. Each box shall be lined with a sealed, waterproof bag, or its equivalent, made from material conforming to the requirements of Joint Army-Navy Specification JAN–P–125, for case liners; seams and closures shall be sealed with water-resistant adhesive conforming to the requirements of Joint Army-Navy Specification JAN–P–140.

7.2.3.3 *Packing variation permitted.*—If the number of units in any shipment is not the exact multiple of the number of units specified to be contained in each shipping container, the units not constituting the nearest such multiple shall be packed in a shipping container of suitable size and design and so constructed as to insure safe delivery to the specified destination.

7.2.4 *Marking.*

7.2.4.1 *Interior packages.*—Each unit package and intermediate package shall be marked with the stock number, nomenclature, unit, quantity, and the name of the contractor.

7.2.4.2 *Shipping containers.*

7.2.4.2.1 *Army.*—Each shipping container shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of U. S. Army Specification 100–2.

7.2.4.2.2 *Navy.*—Each shipping container shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of the Navy Shipment Marking Handbook.

7.2.5 *Ordering data.*—Requests, requisitions, schedules, and contracts or orders should specify whether the subject commodity is to be packed and shipping containers marked for domestic or overseas shipment. (See 7.2.3 and 7.2.4.2.)

NAVY: MS

This specification is a part of Section IV, Part 5, of the Federal Standard Stock Catalog

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